Conscious Inclusion

eLearning course transcript

About this course:

Welcome to Conscious Inclusion Training.

Conscious Inclusion is about each of us recognising the impact we have on creating a culture of #BeCompletelyYou at Fujitsu.

This e-learning will help you become aware of your unconscious bias, so you can choose to take action and be consciously inclusive in the workplace.

Section 1: Welcome

1.1 Welcome to Conscious Inclusion Training

Conscious Inclusion is about each of us recognising the impact we have on creating a culture of #BeCompletelyYou at Fujitsu.

We value diversity and want everyone to be comfortable to be themselves at work. However, we all have biases – these are natural human traits, where our brains make quick decisions in order to process large amounts of information quickly. But unconscious bias in the workplace impacts recruitment decisions and employee development, impairing diversity and retention rates, as well as promoting a disconnected culture.

This e-learning will help you become aware of your unconscious bias, so you can choose to take action and be consciously inclusive in the workplace.

This e-learning course is for employees at all levels, and it will take approximately 40 minutes to complete.

You don't have 40 minutes? Do not worry, your progress will be automatically saved, so you can complete the course at your own pace. You can also click on the three lines in the top left corner of your screen to check your progress.

1.2 Learning Objectives

This course aims to help you move from unconscious bias to conscious

inclusion. To do so, it will:

- Give you an introduction to equality, diversity and inclusion.
- Explore what unconscious bias is and the different types of bias.
- Recognise how unconscious bias affects people and behaviour.
- Identify how unconscious bias can impact the workplace.
- Give you top tips for managing bias and action planning

1.3 Introduction

Diversity and inclusion is essential for our future growth and Fujitsu's success. In this course,

 © Fujitsu 2022

you will learn more about how we can practically embrace diversity and create an inclusive culture for every single person at Fujitsu.

A message from President Tokita San:
"In seeking to become a digital transformation company, diversity and inclusion are absolutely essential. Customer needs and the issues facing society are rapidly changing: we need diversity and an inclusive culture that can accommodate these diverse needs. The creativity and diversity of all of you is extremely important: it is the driver of Fujitsu's future growth."

Section 2: Diversity, Equity and Inclusion

2.1 Our Purpose

Our purpose is to make the world more sustainable by building trust in society through innovation. Diversity and inclusion are essential to achieving our purpose. We want to be a global responsible business that reflects the diversity of our customers and the societies in which we operate. We are committed globally to achieving the UN Sustainable Development Goals, and for diversity and inclusion, goals 5, 10 and 16 are key.

Goal 5: Gender Equality

Goal 10: Reduced Inequalities

Goal 16: Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions

2.2 Inclusion is at the heart of our business

Be completely you. Empowered by Diversity, Equity and Inclusion.
Fujitsu's Diversity, Equity and Inclusion vision is for us to build an inclusive and equitable culture where everyone belongs and can be completely themselves. In addition, our strategy looks further than just our internal business, but how our technology and solutions impact society. Through inclusive design and innovation, we will endeavour to make a positive impact within society and empower each other to make the world more sustainable.

Our Vision: Be a responsible business that reflects the diversity of our world. Build an inclusive and equitable culture where everyone belongs and can be completely themselves.

Strategic goals:

- Make a positive difference in society
- Enable innovation
- Build stronger customer and partner relationships
- Create a sense of belonging
- Cultivate an inclusive and equitable culture
- Build and maintain a diverse talented workforce
- Increase employee engagement

Our focus area:

- Gender

 © Fujitsu 2022

- Health, Disability and Accessibility
- Culture and Ethnicity
- LGBTI+
- Inter-generations

2.3 Definitions

- Equality: Ensuring employees have equal opportunities and are treated fairly.
- Diversity: Simply means difference. Someone's background, ethnicity, ability, values, etc. Inclusion: Respecting, valuing and leveraging the skills and talents of your colleagues.
- Belonging: Is where everyone can be their full and authentic self #BeCompletelyYou.

To explain diversity and inclusion, Verna Myers coined the saying, “Diversity is being invited to the party, inclusion is being asked to dance.”

Inclusion is essential when we have a diverse workforce. Inclusion is about celebrating difference, ensuring each individual is valued and respected for their capabilities and behaviours. It’s about people feeling safe and without fear of discrimination or harassment. We sum up our inclusive culture at Fujitsu as #BeCompletelyYou…. Because when we are part of an inclusive culture, we are comfortable to be completely ourselves.

Belonging is at the heart of this…. By embracing each of our diversity focus areas, ensuring equity and an inclusive culture, we ensure everyone can #BeCompletelyYou

But, equity is not the same as equality! Equity is about giving everyone has what they need to participate and advance, and this may be different for different people.

2.4 Understanding Diversity and Inclusion

Attracting a diverse workforce will not automatically create an inclusive work environment. Nancy Curl and Joerg Schmitz explain the relationships between diversity and inclusion, based on how these can manifest in the workplace, in their book: The Guide to Inclusive Leaders.

High Diversity and Low Inclusion could result in:

- frustration and conflict
- low work satisfaction
- high employee turnover
- low loyalty with the organisation
- low creativity and innovation

Low Diversity and Low Inclusion can lead to:

- low conflict low work satisfaction (for some)
- low employee turnover
- low loyalty with the company (for some)
- low creativity and innovation

 © Fujitsu 2022

High Inclusion and Low Diversity can lack diversity of perspectives, experiences and innovative ideas, as well as:

- high work satisfaction too
- low employee turnover
- low adaptability/agility risk of “Groupthink”
- low creativity and innovation

High Diversity and High Inclusion is the goal for organisations to achieve with notable benefits:

- high work satisfaction
- “healthy” employee turnover
- high loyalty with the organisation
- high adaptability/agility
- high creativity and innovation
-

(Source: The Guide to inclusive Leaders (Joerg Schmitz and Nancy Curl))

Groupthink can occur when groups strive for consensus when making a decision but fail to account for different perspectives to the norm. By accounting for different perspectives that will help to consider the decision from many different viewpoints. Strong desires for low conflict and a quick decision cloud people’s judgement, leading to a decision which is not ideal.

Example: Swissair was once so successful it was called the "Flying Bank." Swissair was once so successful it was called the "Flying Bank." They began to believe they were invulnerable and as a result of failing to question poor decisions and gross mismanagement, the airline eventually went bankrupt.

2.5 Barriers to Diversity and Inclusion

Take a moment to reflect on the information about Equuity, Diversity, and Inclusion so far. In your own time, think about the questions below:

- Where does our organisation sit on the graph of Inclusion VS Diversity?
- What do you see as the potential barriers for Diversity and Inclusion?
- Have you experienced any barriers yourself?
- Do you feel a sense of belonging?
- Can you bring your full, authentic self to work?

When you are ready, watch the video below. If you’d like to watch the video with subtitles, click or tap on the ‘Subtitles/closed captions’ icon on the bottom right corner of the video. The icon will show after you press play.

VIDEO: Inclusion Start with I by Accenture: video transcript

It's the unease of walking into a meeting where no one else looks like me... and the unease of being judged when I leave early to pick up my children.

It's the frustration when I am not asked for my opinion or talked over in meetings... and the frustration of asserting my opinion, only to be labelled aggressive or angry.

 © Fujitsu 2022

It's the annoyance when people presume I am less committed to my family life because I am a man... and the annoyance when people presume I am less committed to my work because I am a mother.

It's the pressure to be super-human and not talk about how I'm really feeling...and the pressure to fit in.

It's the anxiety of sharing my personal life because most people around me are heterosexual... and the anxiety of how others will react to my disability.

It's the awkwardness when I get mistaken for someone else of the same ethnicity... and the awkwardness when my client assumes that my white male colleague is in charge.

It's the strain of feeling I am expected to do more, simply because I don't have children... and the strain when conversations aren't in my first language.

It's the exasperation of being labelled entitled and lacking drive... and the exasperation when people assume I don't have relevant skills or ambition anymore.

It's the indignation of feeling that my promotion is not celebrated as much as others... and the indignation when you think I was promoted just because I am a woman.

It's about the everyday. It's about the big and the small.

It's about the fact that... for every $100 a woman makes, a man makes

$258... Women of colour hold 3% of C-Suite positions.

7 in 10 working fathers want to work more flexibly.

Disabled people are significantly more likely to experience unfair treatment at work than non-disabled people.

Transgender people are twice as likely to be unemployed and are four times as likely to live in poverty.

1 in 4 of us will experience a mental health issue each year... and team performance improves by 50% when everyone feels included.

Inclusion & Diversity is not just about... Gender, Ethnicity, Sexual Orientation, Background, Disability, Culture, Age, Mental Health.

It's about you. It's about me. It's about all of

us. We are all human.

We are all unique. And we all just want a chance. A chance to feel valued and respected for who we are ...and for our differences to be embraced as strengths.

Inclusion promotes belonging, purpose and wellbeing.

Diversity ignites creativity, problem solving and

innovation.

It's about the type of world we want to live in and the choices we make

every day. It's the vision of a better world for our children.

 © Fujitsu 2022

And all it takes is one. One person to care. One commitment to act. Be the one.

Join the conversation.

#InclusionStartsWithI

Section 3: What is Unconscious Bias?

3.1 Activity 1: Who is who?

Looking at the picture below, who is an astrophysicist and who is a basketball player?

Match the description with the letter of the picture based on what first comes to your mind.

Picture A: Young, African American black male with long hair wearing loose outfit.
Picture B: Young, Asian American, white male, wearing suite and tie.

Response: On picture A there is Jeremy Lin who is a basketball player and on picture B there is Neil deGrasse Tyson who is an Astrophysicist.

Unless we recognised them, it is likely that most of us got this question wrong. The fact is that we prejudge and categorise people based on limited information such as a picture, a name, gender, ethnicity etc. and this is what we call unconscious bias.

3.2 Activity 2: The ball and the bat

Try and answer this quickly: A bat and a ball cost £1.10. The bat costs £1 more than the ball. How much does the ball cost?

a) 10p
b) 5p
c) 15p

Response: The bat is £1 more than the ball, the ball must be 5p because 5p + £1.05 = £1.10 The usual instinctive response is 10p (which would equal £1.20). Over 50% of people from some of the world's leading universities chose 10p. But why do so many people get this wrong and what has this got to do with unconscious bias? This a great example of our unconscious mind in action. Posed with what looks like a simple maths problem we use intuition instead of analysis to make a quick decision that proves to be incorrect.

3.3 What is Unconscious Bias?

Unconscious biases, also known as Implicit Bias, are our unintentional people preferences, formed by our background, personal experiences, societal stereotypes, and cultural context. Unconscious biases are the result of our limited cognitive capacity; we implicitly and automatically both group and categorise people to avoid having to conduct completely new assessments for every new person. We unconsciously assign positive and negative values to the categories we use.

 © Fujitsu 2022

Watch the video below for more information on 'What is Unconscious Bias?'

VIDEO: 'What is Unconscious Bias?' video transcript

New research from the fields of neuroscience and social psychology has shed light on the concept of Unconscious Bias. But what exactly is Unconscious Bias and how does it affect our behaviours and decisions?

Unconscious biases are simply our unintended people preferences. They are formed by our socialisation, our personal experiences and the representation of different groups in the media.

These experiences act as social filters in which we make assessments and judgements of people around us. Research tells us that human beings have a natural tendency to place individuals into social categories. These categories are often based on visual cues, such as gender, cultural background, age, height or body size. We also categorise based on social background, job roles, religious identity or political affiliation.

The unconscious brain uses associations based on social categories to develop biases. For example, if we are constantly exposed to women as primary school teachers or receptionists, or men as plumbers or organisational leaders, these associations become wired within the human brain.

3.4 Some Facts

Unconscious bias can have a significant influence on our attitudes and behaviours, especially towards other people. It can influence key decisions in the workplace and can contribute to inequality, for example in selection and recruitment, appraisals, or promotion. Below are some examples.

- Discrimination in recruitment: BBC's Inside Out London sent CVs from two candidates, "Adam" and "Mohamed", who had identical skills and experience, in response to 100 job opportunities: Adam was offered 12 interviews, Mohamed was offered 4. (*Source*: BBC)
- Hurricanes: An analysis of more than six decades of death rates from United States hurricanes by the University of Illinois shows that severe hurricanes with a more feminine name result in a greater death toll. It is suggested that people conclude that a storm with a feminine name is seen as less threatening than one with a more masculine name. As a result, people in the path of these severe storms may take fewer protective measures, leaving them more vulnerable to harm. (*Source*: University of Illinois)
- Attitudes around disability: In a series of research studies looking at people's attitudes towards disability, over a third (36%) of people tend to think of disabled people as less productive. (*Source*: University of Bristol)
- Bodyweight: A study showed when a woman's Body Mass Index (BMI) reaches 27+, they begin to experience discrimination due to their weight. Men aren't at serious risk of weight- related bias until they reach a BMI of 35+. (*Source*: International Journal of Obesity)
- Science, Technology, Engineering and Maths (STEM): While boys are

 © Fujitsu 2022

expected to perform better in STEM-related areas than girls, researchers discovered that girls actually outperform their male counterparts in maths and science exams when the tests are graded anonymously. The finding concludes that when marking exams of STEM subjects, teachers tend to overestimate male students' abilities while underestimating female students', resulting in a negative long-term impact on their attitudes toward the subjects and future career paths. (*Source*: Frontiers)

3.5 Two 'Thinking' Systems

We receive 11 million bits of information every moment. We can consciously process around 40 bits of this. 99.999996% is unconscious. (from Google's presentation on unconscious bias)

Before we move any further, read the riddle (puzzle) below.

A father and son have a car accident and are both badly hurt. They are both taken to separate hospitals. When the boy is taken in for an operation, the surgeon says: "I cannot do the surgery because this is my son". How is this possible?

Response: The original response to this riddle is that the surgeon is the boy's mother. But of course, another correct response could be that the boy has two fathers.

Our brains use two thinking systems that operate simultaneously.

System 1 (fast) thinking

System 1 thinking is an instinctive, unconscious, highly efficient mental process that we have no control over or awareness of.

- It helps us automate our thought patterns and behaviour;
- It continuously processes data, hard-wring our brains and categorising people;
- It enables us to make rapid decisions about people, based on previous information acquired;
- It is based on intuition and impressions, so it can often be incorrect.

For example, society has presented you with representations of what it means to be a surgeon, a firefighter, a nurse, etc. These representations are repeated by media, teachers, and influencers. Once internalised, these stereotypes shape your thoughts and actions, allowing you to instantly make decisions based on assumptions.

Thinking back to our riddle, many people struggle to come up with an answer because they automatically assume "surgeon" means "male surgeon" and therefore should be the father.

System 2 (slow) thinking

System 2 thinking is a controlled, effortful, and logical mode in which our brains operate when solving more complicated problems. It is when you challenge your automatic reactions and slowly consider your response.

It needs to be switched on and requires effort. It is rule-driven, deciding to follow guidance or a complex process. It evaluates based on presented information rather

 © Fujitsu 2022

than associated links. Helps to regulate our fast thinking to then come away with a reliable thought process or response.

3.6 What makes system 1 thinking more dominant?

These four things make system 1 more dominant in our day-to-day:

- Stress: Fast thinking is more dominant when we are stressed, take a moment to de- stress in whichever way works for you. Although it is easier said than done, try not to approach decision making whilst stressed.
- Time: Fast thinking is more dominant when we are under a time restraint. An example of this could be a last-minute CV sift for a new position resulting in a potentially biased result.
- Hunger or thirst: Fast thinking is more dominant when we are hungry or thirsty. It is important to stay well hydrated, this we know. One example to reduce the dominance of fast thinking could be to not interview right before lunch.
- Tiredness: Fast thinking is more dominant when we are tired. Slow thinking takes effort to use, meaning that if we are tired, fast thinking will come into play for an easier, less demanding process. Try to get your recommended or optimal hours of sleep per night or hold off on a late-night decision to stop bias creeping in.

Section 4: Types of Bias

4.1 Affinity Bias

Individuals and groups gravitate towards people like them. Typically, it is easier to socialise and interact with those from a similar background to us. Commonness leads to comfort, which leads to trust and some people being seen as more competent.

Watch the video below for more information on affinity bias.

'VIDEO: Affinity Bias' video transcript

The unconscious brain uses social categories to make unconscious judgments about people who are similar to us and people who are different from us. A common form of Unconscious Bias is Affinity Bias. This type of bias impacts talent processes in organisation decision- making, including:

How we recruit: managers are more likely to hire people who look similar or with sounding names to them.

Work allocation: managers are more likely to assign key client projects to individuals within their teams, who they have an Unconscious Affinity with.

Performance: where there is some kind of affinity, managers are more likely to spend time informally discussing positive contributions to the team and will focus on development and future work plans.

For those where there is little affinity, managers are more likely to question past performance. The conversation will be less friendly and even hostile at times.

 © Fujitsu 2022

How to avoid it? Actively take note of the similarities you share with a colleague or a candidate so that you can differentiate between attributes that may influence your judgement and the concrete skills, experiences and unique qualities that could contribute to your organisation as a 'culture add' rather than a 'culture fit'.

How to avoid affinity bias?
Actively take note of the similarities you share with a colleague or a candidate so that you can differentiate between attributes that may influence your judgement and the concrete skills, experiences and unique qualities that could contribute to your organisation as a 'culture add' rather than a 'culture fit'.

4.2 Confirmation Bias

Confirmation Bias is the cognitive process where we put emphasis on and favouring information that confirms our existing bias or belief. An example of this could be a preconceived idea on any topic. If investigated further, people will seek stories, research or other people's anecdotes that back up their original beliefs and ignore everything else that is presented. In the workplace, preconceived ideas about groups of people can be devastating. Confirmation Bias can have an impact on performance reviews, promotions, opportunities and more.

Below are some examples.

- A doctor who has jumped to one hypothesis as to what disease a patient has, may then ask questions and look for evidence that tends to confirm the initial diagnosis. They can also overlook evidence that would tend to disconfirm it. (Source: Groopman, 2007)
- A candidate has a weak handshake, the interviewer then thinks they are probably weak, not a leader and just not a good fit. They may possibly seek further confirmation of this initial opinion throughout the interview and ignore contradictory information.
- "Fake news" has plagued social media in recent years and the existence of confirmation bias has helped to support this. When we see a piece of information, we try to decide if we should believe it or not. If this new information supports pre-existing beliefs, then it is likely to be liked and shared.

How to avoid confirmation bias?
During recruitment, ask standardised questions that provide each candidate with a fair chance to stand out. Give everyone in the organisation an equal opportunity to progress with equal access to development opportunities, coaching and mentoring, not just certain people who share your opinions and experiences.

4.3 Other Types of Bias in the Workplace

Attribution Bias
Believing that our own achievements or errors (or of those in our group) are deserved or justifiable, but others' achievements or errors (out-group members) are due to luck or their own character.

 © Fujitsu 2022

A colleague who is 'like us' is often late because they have to commute and we all know that trains are often delayed. Whereas the person in our out-group simply needs to get out of bed earlier.

How to avoid attribution bias? Do not rush your judgements. Take time to reflect on the assumptions you are making about people. Ask colleagues to outline and detail the reasons behind the decisions they are proposing. Give candidates or employees a chance to share their full story with you before making your judgements..

Benevolence Bias
This occurs when efforts to be kind result in decision making on other people's behalf that takes away their choice.

A new mum might be discounted for attendance at an overseas conference in order to spare her added stress. This is a conscious decision underpinned by a multitude of unconscious assumptions about motherhood which may ultimately harm her career.

How to avoid benevolence bias? Let people make their own decisions and do not assume what's best for someone without asking.

Conformity Bias
Can take place in situations where, in order to be accepted by a social group, people will tend to agree with the views of the majority within the group regardless of what they might think on an individual basis.

This can lead to systemic thinking. This is when the whole organisation operates in a biased way because it has never been challenged such as with processes, policies, procedures etc.

How to avoid confirmation bias? Use anonymous surveys to collect employees' opinions. In a team meeting, ensure everyone’s opinions are encouraged and invited and are considered.

Gender Bias

This is the preference or prejudice toward one gender compared to others.

An American research group sent two CVs to 127 male and female professors for consideration for a laboratory manager position. Both fictional candidates were white, aged 22 and had identical grades and comparable references.

"John" was more likely to be hired than "Jennifer" with an extra $4,000 more starting salary.

How to avoid gender bias? Conduct anonymous screenings of applications that exclude aspects of a candidate that may reveal their assumed gender..

The Halo Effect

The halo effect is where putting someone's positive qualities in one area influences

 © Fujitsu 2022

the perception of them in other areas.

A classic example would be assuming that because someone is a great team performer, they will also make a great manager or leader.

How to avoid the halo effect? Assess someone's suitability for a role or project based on their skills and experiences vs. specific requirements, and not based on an attribute a person may stand out for.

The Horns Effect

The horns effect is where putting someone's negative qualities in one area influences the perception of them in other areas.

An example could be if someone holds an opinion that doesn't sit well with you, you start to dislike everything else they say.

How to avoid the horns effect? Assess someone's suitability for a role or project based on their skills and experiences vs. specific requirements, and not your personal opinions or views.

Language Bias

Language bias refers to the idea that we are inclined to favour those who communicate in the same way as us: People who speak our language, have the same accent, and use similar slang. Sometimes the terms language bias and biased language are used interchangeably when they are, in fact, not one and the same.

Whereas language bias refers to the idea that we favour those who communicate like us, biased language refers to the actual words and phrases we use that exclude, reduce, or offend people by failing to account for some aspect of their identity.

How to avoid language bias? The more we all use inclusive, unbiased language, the more natural it will feel and the more common it will become. Developing awareness about language preferences and identifying and confronting stereotypes. Get to know the individual rather than relying on a stereotype about their communication style. As a rule of thumb, whenever you're not sure what language to use when speaking about a person or community, ask them directly about their preferred terminology, or language preferences. It's always better to ask and learn than to say something well-intentioned but hurtful.

Section 5: The Impact of Unconscious Bias

5.1 Do you remember this BBC Interview?

Back in 2017, a video of Robert Kelly (International Relations professor) went viral as his interview with the BBC was briefly interrupted by his two small children.

But who was the person that came to Robert Kelly's rescue in the video?

People on social media and some news outlets were quick to note the speed of the "nanny" coming in to help when in reality Jung-a Kim was Robert Kelly's wife. This is an example of unconscious bias based on racial stereotypes, resulting in microaggression.

 © Fujitsu 2022

5.2 Micro-Behaviours: Inequities

Micro-Inequities are small events which are often fast, hard-to-prove, covert, unintentional, and frequently unrecognised by those displaying them. Micro-Inequities usually occur when people are perceived to be "different" - Mary Rowe, 1973.

Some other examples of these may include:

- Rolling your eyes or sighing loudly at someone's suggestions or ideas
- Mentioning the achievements of some people at a meeting but not others whose achievements are equally relevant
- Only reading half of a person's email and then asking the person about the content later
- Avoiding eye contact
- Adopting negative or aggressive body language
- Changing your tone of voice

Micro-Inequities often have serious and harmful effects, resulting in hostile work environments. Micro-Inequities are problematic because they consist of micro-messages that are hard to recognise for victims, bystanders, and perpetrators.

When victims of Micro-Inequities recognise the micro-messages, it is usually difficult to explain to others why these small behaviours can cause a **bigger problem**.

Negative micro-behaviours are known as Micro-Inequities and Aggressions.

Watch the video below for more information on micro-behaviours.

VIDEO: ´Micro-Behaviours´ video transcript

Unconscious Bias often results in a set of micro-behaviours. Examples of positive micro- behaviours include supporting the ideas of someone with who you have an Unconscious Affinity whilst in a team meeting.

Or simply wanting to have coffee with someone like you. Examples of negative micro- behaviours include, checking emails on your phone whilst talking to a colleague, or cutting someone off in a meeting.

Often our intention is not to make biased decisions and through a focus on conscious thinking and by creating inclusive work cultures, we can learn to control our unconscious judgements and mitigate the impact of bias on our talent programmes.

5.3 Micro-Behaviours: Aggressions

As with Micro-Inequities, Micro-Aggressions can be slow-building, resulting in incremental damage over time. This could be likened to a snowball effect.

Micro-Aggressions are a statement, action, or incident regarded as an instance of indirect, subtle, or unintentional discrimination against members of an

 © Fujitsu 2022

underrepresented group such as a racial or ethnic minority. They are acts that stereotype the recipient.

Any minority group in society such as LGBTQ (Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, Trans, Queer) people, women, disabled people, religious groups and other groups can be met with Micro-Aggressions.

Some examples are listed below.

- Disability: Telling a blind person that "I can't imagine being in your position, I don't know how you do it" or referring to someone's disability as a “Special need”.
- Religion: An older Christian person telling an Atheist that "you'll probably change your mind when you get older" or "You can't be Jewish, you don't have that Jewish look".
- Trans: Excess focus on anatomical sex markers, most usually reproductive organs; or misgendering (saying “he” instead of “she” or “they”) and inappropriate transphobic slurs such as “tranny”.
- Ethnicity/Race: To a non-white colleague - in a mostly white office: "So, where are you from? ...No, I mean, where are you really from?" or "You speak really good English considering where you're from".
- Sex: A female physician wearing a stethoscope is mistaken for a nurse. or A male nurse is met with "Wow, you don't get many male nurses".
- Sexual orientation: To a colleague who has talked about their same-sex partner: "Huh, you don't sound gay." or "Are you the man or the woman in the relationship?".

5.4 Micro-Behaviours: Affirmations and Advantages

Micro-Inequities and aggressions and associated micro-messages occur as a manifestation of unconscious bias. So, what is the antidote to this? They are known as Micro-Affirmations and Micro-Advantages.

Micro-Affirmations are subtle acknowledgements of a person's value and accomplishments which create a sense of belonging.

Micro-Advantages are facial expressions, gestures, choice of words and tones. They are even more subtle but just as important.

When a workplace culture adopts this way of behaving, it can only lead to positive output and satisfaction.

Below are some seemingly small but massively positive behaviours you can adopt with the attached benefits!

- Saying hello or how are you to someone. This can have a huge impact on people, especially if you are a senior member of the team.
- Opening a door for someone, being considerate and generally showing respect for others.
- Publicly acknowledging and giving credit to someone for something they have said or done.

 © Fujitsu 2022

- Listening to someone in a time of distress or when it is clear they need someone to really listen.
- Nodding your head, smiling, making eye contact are all active listening signals. These, combined with the tone of your voice, demonstrate micro-affirmations.

Section 6: Top Tips and Action Planning

6.1 Top Tips for All

Here are some tips on how you can overcome your bias.

- Take the Harvard Implicit Association Test to measure your own bias. You can access the test here.
- Challenge your peer group on their decisions - stand up for your views, especially regarding recruitment.
- Slow down your decision making - take a break.
- Extend who you trust and identify how you allocate work - talk to people, understand them and build trust.
- Break your thinking patterns - read a different newspaper, get news from a different app. Who are you having catch-ups with?
- Expand your network - who would you not normally network with? If you find yourself in a new group, don't gravitate to the same people you normally would, get to know others.

6.2 Top Tips for Managers

- Be an inquisitive manager. Really listen to people and what they are presenting.
- Create diverse teams, look at de-biasing the recruitment cycle.
- Be mindful when you allocate work. Are you giving everyone the chance to shine or is it focused on the 'in-group'.
- Review your performance management scores: how are these decided and are they free from bias?
- Coach or mentor someone who is not like you or consider a reverse mentoring programme.

6.3 Action Planning

We don't see things as they are, we see them as we are. (Quote from Rabbi Shemuel ben Nachmani)

Reflecting on all the information in this course, consider any eye-opening or 'oh' moments where you may have identified something that could benefit you, your interactions with others and our organisation.

6.4 Activity: Take action!

Complete the sentence: *I will change/I will do/I will start to...*

Examples may be:

- I will make an effort to catch up with colleagues that I used to avoid or thought

 © Fujitsu 2022

that I don't have anything in common with.

- I will use the information and facts presented rather than be driven by biased thinking.
- I will question my bias and that of others I will understand that people questioning me are not aggressively challenging me but are wanting me to see a different perspective.
- I will challenge my thought processes when making decisions.

6.5 Inclusion starts with our own behaviour

You can also get involved in Fujitsu's wider commitment to achieving the UN Sustainable Development Goals - learn more here:

- For Gender Equality (SDG 5):
  Watch 'SDG 5: Gender Equality' | Microsoft Stream
- For Reduced Inequalities (SDG 10):
  Watch 'SDG 10: Reduced Inequalities' | Microsoft Stream
- For Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions (SDG 16):
  Watch 'SDG 16: Peace, Justice and Strong Institutions' | Microsoft Stream

6.6 Contacts

Contact your local HR or Diversity, Equity & Inclusion team via the Europe Compass Human Resources site.

 © Fujitsu 2022